UMMAH ONE

Art & Culture Guide

81 destinations · Living heritage · Art & music · Markets · Fashion · Handicrafts

Explore culture, creativity and local traditions

A practical, city-by-city guide to cultural institutions, historic districts, traditional markets, creative spaces and living craft traditions across 81 destinations.

Inside this guide

- 81 city and destination entries, organised by region
- Culture, art and music highlights for each destination
- Markets, shopping streets and fashion districts
- Handicraft places, artisan areas and traditional craft practices
- Practical visitor tips for checking access, schedules and workshops

Use this guide as a starting point for discovering places, traditions and local makers.

How to use this guide

1. Choose a destination

Use the destination index to find a city or region. Entries are grouped geographically so you can compare nearby destinations and plan a wider trip.

2. Explore the three guide sections

Culture, art & music highlights museums, heritage sites, creative spaces, performances and local traditions. Markets & fashion points to souqs, bazaars, shopping streets and contemporary retail areas. Handicraft places highlights craft districts, artisan centres, workshops and places associated with traditional making.

3. Plan your visit

Check the venue’s official information for opening hours, tickets, closures, photography rules and access. For markets, confirm the operating day and location, as some rotate by weekday or season.

4. Arrange workshops and performances

Contact the venue or artisan cooperative directly. Confirm whether visitors can observe or participate, whether booking is required, the duration, language availability and any fee. Performance dates and programmes can change.

5. Shop thoughtfully

Ask who made an item, where it was produced, which materials and techniques were used, and whether it is handmade locally. Distinguish local craft from imported or mass-produced souvenirs.

6. Be a respectful visitor

Ask permission before photographing artisans, performers, residents or worship spaces. Respect restricted areas and local expectations around dress and conduct. Check accessibility and family facilities directly with each venue.

A useful reminder

Venue access, market schedules, demonstrations and performances may change. Confirm details locally before travelling.

Destination index

Middle East & Gulf

Dubai · Abu Dhabi · Sharjah · AlUla · Jeddah · Riyadh · Abha · Al Ahsa · Dammam · Doha · Muscat · Salalah · Manama · Kuwait City · Amman · Aqaba · Baku · Ganja

Türkiye

Istanbul · Cappadocia (Göreme) · Antalya · Bodrum · Pamukkale · Fethiye · Izmir · Trabzon · Bursa · Marmaris · Alanya · Konya · Ankara

Balkans

Kotor · Budva · Podgorica · Mostar · Sarajevo · Ohrid · Skopje · Tetovo · Tirana · Prizren · Pristina

North Africa

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Central Asia

Samarkand · Bukhara · Tashkent · Khiva · Almaty · Astana · Turkistan · Shymkent · Bishkek · Dushanbe

Russia

Kazan

Southeast & South Asia

Bali · Yogyakarta · Kuala Lumpur · Penang · Langkawi · Malé · Baa Atoll · Hunza Valley · Skardu

Thailand

Satun · Koh Lanta

India

Kozhikode · Lakshadweep · Hyderabad · Lucknow

East Africa

Zanzibar City (Stone Town)

Middle East & Gulf

18 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Dubai, UAE

Culture, art & music
Museum of the Future; Global Village cultural pavilions (October–May). Alserkal Avenue (Al Quoz), a contemporary art and creative district.

Markets & fashion
Gold Souk and Spice Souk in Deira; Textile Souk in Bur Dubai; Perfume Souk; Al Fahidi Historical Neighbourhood; Dubai Mall and Mall of the Emirates.

Handicraft places
Explore traditional products at Global Village; browse textiles and tailoring shops in the Textile Souk; see jewellery-making and gold work around the Gold Souk.

Add Alserkal Avenue (Al Quoz) as a major contemporary-art and creative district. It complements the historic souks: the former warehouse district hosts galleries, design, performance and cultural programming. [1]

Abu Dhabi, UAE

Culture, art & music
Louvre Abu Dhabi; teamLab Phenomena; Heritage Village.

Markets & fashion
The Souk at Qaryat Al Beri; Souk Al Zafarana in Al Ain (day trip); Mina Market; Marina Mall.

Handicraft places
House of Artisans at Qasr Al Hosn for talli embroidery, Al Sadu weaving and khoos palm weaving; The Souk at Qaryat Al Beri for handmade goods, carpets and traditional products.

Add the distinction that Al Talli is UAE-inscribed intangible heritage (2022), while UAE Al Sadu is a separate national element. House of Artisans at Qasr Al Hosn interprets Talli, Al Sadu and Khoos and may offer scheduled workshops. [4, 5]

Sharjah, UAE

Culture, art & music
Arts festivals; Sharjah Museum of Islamic Civilization; Sharjah Art Foundation; UNESCO World Book Capital (2019).

Markets & fashion
Central Souq (Blue Souk); Souq Al Arsah; Souq Saqr.

Handicraft places
Souq Al Arsah and the Heart of Sharjah for traditional crafts, textiles, antiques and souvenirs; Sharjah Heritage Museum for context on local craft traditions.

Editorial correction: Sharjah was UNESCO World Book Capital in 2019; this is a historical designation, not a current annual status. Keep Sharjah Art Foundation as a current arts institution and check its live exhibition calendar. [2, 3]

AlUla, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
Maraya Concert Hall; Winter at Tantora; AlJadidah Arts District; Desert X AlUla.

Markets & fashion
AlUla Old Town Market Street and shops around the Old Town.

Handicraft places
Explore artisan stalls and locally made products along Old Town Market Street; check current craft demonstrations and workshops through Experience AlUla.

Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
Hayy Jameel arts complex; Corniche open-air sculpture park; Nasseef House.

Markets & fashion
Souq Al Alawi in Al-Balad; Bab Makkah Market; Red Sea Mall and Mall of Arabia.

Handicraft places
Walk Al-Balad’s historic lanes around Souq Al Alawi and Nasseef House for traditional goods, carved wooden architecture and local artisan shops.

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
National Museum; Riyadh Season; JAX District studios; Diriyah.

Markets & fashion
Souq Al Zal for carpets, antiques and traditional goods; Diriyah’s shops and cultural district.

Handicraft places
Explore traditional products at Souq Al Zal and heritage displays and artisan retail around At-Turaif and Bujairi Terrace in Diriyah.

Add Al Sadu weaving as a Saudi tradition within the multinational UNESCO inscription shared with Kuwait and Qatar (extended in 2025). Do not describe Riyadh itself as the location of the inscription. [6]

Abha, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
Al Qatt Al Asiri wall art; Al Muftaha Arts Village; summer festivals.

Markets & fashion
Tuesday Market (Souq Al Thulatha) and local shops around Al Muftaha Arts Village.

Handicraft places
Al Muftaha Arts Village for regional art; Tuesday Market for Al Qatt Al Asiri-inspired products, textiles and handmade items.

Al Ahsa, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
Al Ahsa Dates Festival.

Markets & fashion
Al Qaisariya Souq in Hofuf; Souq Al Khamis.

Handicraft places
Explore traditional goods and local makers around Al Qaisariya Souq; look for palm-weaving products, pottery and bisht tailoring.

Dammam, Saudi Arabia

Culture, art & music
Ithra (King Abdulaziz Center for World Culture), in nearby Dhahran.

Markets & fashion
Qatif Market; Al Rashid Mall; Mall of Dhahran.

Handicraft places
Explore traditional products and local sellers in Qatif’s markets; visit Ithra in nearby Dhahran for cultural exhibitions and craft-related programming.

Doha, Qatar

Culture, art & music
Museum of Islamic Art; National Museum of Qatar; Msheireb Museums; Katara Cultural Village.

Markets & fashion
Souq Waqif; Falcon Souq; Msheireb Downtown shops.

Handicraft places
Souq Waqif's craft and handicraft shops for weaving, textiles, jewellery and traditional objects; visit the Msheireb Museums for context on Qatari heritage.

Add Al Sadu weaving as a living Bedouin textile tradition. UNESCO extended the multinational inscription to include Qatar in 2025, alongside Saudi Arabia and Kuwait. This is not the same listing as the UAE's separate Al Sadu element. [6]

Muscat, Oman

Culture, art & music
Royal Opera House Muscat; National Museum of Oman; Bait Al Zubair.

Markets & fashion
Mutrah Souq; Oman Avenues Mall; traditional shops around Old Muscat.

Handicraft places
Mutrah Souq for silver jewellery, khanjars, frankincense and Omani textiles; Bait Al Zubair Museum for traditional dress, jewellery and craft collections.

Salalah, Oman

Culture, art & music
Museum of the Frankincense Land; Khareef Festival (July–August).

Markets & fashion
Al Haffa Souq and the central Salalah souq area.

Handicraft places
Al Haffa Souq for frankincense, bakhoor, incense burners and local souvenirs; ask vendors about Dhofari frankincense products.

Manama, Bahrain

Culture, art & music
Bahrain National Museum; Beit Al Quran; Bahrain National Theatre; Pearling Path.

Markets & fashion
Manama Souq; Muharraq Old Souq; Bab Al Bahrain area.

Handicraft places
Al Jasra Handicrafts Centre for weaving, embroidery, baskets, carved wooden chests and model boats; Muharraq for traditional craft and pearling heritage.

Kuwait City, Kuwait

Culture, art & music
Sheikh Abdullah Al Salem Cultural Centre; Sheikh Jaber Al Ahmad Cultural Centre; Dar al-Athar al-Islamiyyah; Tareq Rajab Museum.

Markets & fashion
Souq Al Mubarakiya; Souq Al Safat.

Handicraft places
Sadu House for traditional Al Sadu weaving; browse Souq Al Mubarakiya for local textiles, perfumes and handmade souvenirs.

Add Sadu House and Al Sadu weaving as key heritage interpretation leads. The 2025 UNESCO inscription is shared by Saudi Arabia, Kuwait and Qatar. Confirm whether a demonstration or workshop is scheduled before promising access. [6]

Amman, Jordan

Culture, art & music
Roman Theatre; Jordan Museum.

Markets & fashion
Downtown Amman souqs; Souk Jara (seasonal); Rainbow Street.

Handicraft places
Jordan River Designs and the Jordan Crafts Centre for handmade products; Souk Jara for local crafts and artisan stalls when operating.

Aqaba, Jordan

Culture, art & music
Aqaba Archaeological Museum; Aqaba Fort; historic port heritage.

Markets & fashion
Aqaba Downtown Market and the souq streets near the waterfront.

Handicraft places
Explore local souvenir and craft shops around Aqaba Fort and the downtown market; coloured sand-bottle workshops and sellers should be confirmed locally.

Baku, Azerbaijan

Culture, art & music
Mugham music; Azerbaijan Carpet Museum; Gala Open-Air Museum.

Markets & fashion
Icherisheher Old City shops; Taza Bazaar; Nizami Street.

Handicraft places
Azerbaijan National Carpet Museum and artisan shops in Icherisheher for carpet weaving, ceramics and traditional souvenirs.

Ganja, Azerbaijan

Culture, art & music
Literary heritage of poet Nizami; History and Ethnography Museum.

Markets & fashion
Ganja Central Bazaar and shops around the city centre.

Handicraft places
Explore local carpet and souvenir sellers around Ganja Central Bazaar; ask about Ganja-Gazakh carpet weaving and regional workshops. Türkiye

Türkiye

13 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Istanbul, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Museums, calligraphy and traditional music.

Markets & fashion
Grand Bazaar; Spice Bazaar; Arasta Bazaar; KadIköy Market.

Handicraft places
Grand Bazaar and Arasta Bazaar for carpets, ceramics, lamps and calligraphy; visit the Turkish and Islamic Arts Museum for historic craft examples.

Cappadocia (Göreme), Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Göreme Open-Air Museum.

Markets & fashion
Göreme town shops; Avanos market and pottery shops.

Handicraft places
Avanos pottery workshops along the KIzIIIrmak River, where visitors can see traditional red-clay pottery demonstrations and browse handmade ceramics.

Clarify that the strongest pottery lead is Avanos, a separate town in Cappadocia. Türkiye’s Ministry of Culture confirms the local earthenware tradition and the use of red clay from the Kızılırmak River. [7]

Antalya, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Aspendos Roman Theatre (day trip); Antalya Museum.

Markets & fashion
Kaleiçi Old Town lanes; Antalya Old Bazaar; local market days.

Handicraft places
Antalya Old Bazaar and Kaleiçi shops for regional textiles, jewellery and souvenirs; check for local carpet and pottery workshops.

Bodrum, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Museum of Underwater Archaeology; Bodrum Castle.

Markets & fashion
Bodrum Tuesday clothing market; YalIkavak market; Turgutreis market.

Handicraft places
Bodrum bazaar and shops between Iskele Square and the old harbour for Milas cloth, embroidery, leather goods, silver jewellery and decorative items.

Pamukkale, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Hierapolis Archaeology Museum.

Markets & fashion
Buldan town textile shops and local markets (day trip from Pamukkale).

Handicraft places
Visit Buldan’s traditional textile shops and workshops for handwoven cotton towels, scarves and fabrics.

Fethiye, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Fethiye Museum; Lycian heritage and local cultural events.

Markets & fashion
Fethiye Tuesday Market; Paspatur Old Town Bazaar.

Handicraft places
Paspatur shops and Fethiye market stalls for carpets, kilims, textiles and local handmade souvenirs; verify workshops before visiting.

Izmir, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Izmir Archaeology Museum; Ethnography Museum; State Painting and Sculpture Museum.

Markets & fashion
KemeraltI Bazaar; KIzlaraIasI Han; BaIdurak area.

Handicraft places
BaIdurak KemeraltI Touristic Handicraft Market for felt-making and leatherwork; KIzlaraIasI Han for traditional crafts and souvenirs.

Trabzon, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Trabzon Museum; Kostaki Mansion.

Markets & fashion
KunduracIlar Street; BakIrcIlar Street; Trabzon Bedesten and old bazaar area.

Handicraft places
Explore BakIrcIlar Street and the old bazaar for copperwork; look for Trabzon hasIrI silver jewellery in specialist workshops and shops.

Bursa, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Karagöz Museum and traditional shadow puppetry.

Markets & fashion
Koza Han; Bursa Grand Bazaar; Uzun ÇarII.

Handicraft places
Koza Han for silk scarves and textiles; nearby workshops and shops for Bursa silk and Iznik tiles (Iznik is a day trip).

Marmaris, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Marmaris Castle Museum.

Markets & fashion
Marmaris Grand Bazaar; Thursday market; shops around the marina.

Handicraft places
Browse the Grand Bazaar and weekly market for leather goods, textiles and souvenirs; verify individual makers for handmade work.

Alanya, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Alanya Archaeological Museum.

Markets & fashion
Alanya Bazaar; Cuma Pazarl; shops in the harbour and Kaleiçi area.

Handicraft places
Alanya Municipality’s Iskele Sanat SokaII, Damlatal Sanat SokaII, Mahmutlar Sanat SokaII, Oba Sanat SokaII and Kale Sanat Tezgâhlarl feature local handmade products, jewellery and crafts.

Konya, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Rumi heritage; whirling dervish ceremonies; Mevlana Museum; Sema performances; Karatay Tile Museum.

Markets & fashion
Bedesten Bazaar; KadInlar Pazarl; Mevlana area shops.

Handicraft places
Konya Bedesten and Mevlana area shops for prayer beads, carpets, copperware and traditional souvenirs; visit the Tile Museum for local tile heritage.

Ankara, Türkiye

Culture, art & music
Museum of Anatolian Civilisations; Erimtan Museum; Koç Museum.

Markets & fashion
Ankara Castle craft streets; Suluhan Bazaar; TunaII Hilmi Street.

Handicraft places
Ankara Castle shops and Suluhan Bazaar for traditional crafts; Beypazarl (day trip) for silverwork and local handicrafts. Balkans

Balkans

11 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Kotor, Montenegro

Culture, art & music
Maritime Museum of Montenegro.

Markets & fashion
Kotor Old Town shops; Kotor Saturday market outside the Old Town walls.

Handicraft places
Browse Old Town galleries and the Saturday market for local artwork, jewellery and handmade souvenirs; ask sellers about regional makers.

Budva, Montenegro

Culture, art & music
Museum of the City of Budva.

Markets & fashion
Budva Old Town lanes; open-air market near the Old Town.

Handicraft places
Old Town galleries and market stalls for local art, jewellery and souvenirs; traditional textiles and embroidery are regional items, not guaranteed at every stall.

Podgorica, Montenegro

Culture, art & music
Contemporary Art Centre; Petrovil Palace.

Markets & fashion
Mall of Montenegro market area; downtown shops; Independence Square during craft fairs.

Handicraft places
Independence Square hosts occasional craft and local-products fairs featuring weaving, embroidery and folk textiles; check the event calendar before visiting.

Mostar, Bosnia and Herzegovina

Culture, art & music
Old Bridge Museum; Blagaj Tekke dervish lodge (day trip).

Markets & fashion
Kujundžiluk Old Bazaar beside the Old Bridge.

Handicraft places
Kujundžiluk’s coppersmith and artisan shops for copper coffee sets, engraved metalwork, carpets and handmade souvenirs.

Sarajevo, Bosnia and Herzegovina

Culture, art & music
Film festivals; Bosnian music; National Museum; Gazi Husrev-beg Museum.

Markets & fashion
Bašlaršija; Kazandžiluk (Coppersmith Street); Gazi Husrev-beg Street.

Handicraft places
Kazandžiluk for copperware and metal engraving; Bašlaršija for traditional crafts, filigree jewellery and textiles.

Ohrid, North Macedonia

Culture, art & music
Icon Gallery; summer festivals.

Markets & fashion
Ohrid Old Bazaar; shops along the lakeside old town.

Handicraft places
Ohrid Pearl workshops and shops in the Old Town; National Workshop for Handmade Paper for traditional paper-making demonstrations.

Skopje, North Macedonia

Culture, art & music
National Gallery at Daut Pasha Hamam; Museum of Contemporary Art.

Markets & fashion
Old Bazaar (Iaršija); Bit Pazar; Bezisten.

Handicraft places
Old Bazaar artisan lanes for filigree jewellery, copperwork, woodcraft and traditional souvenirs; visit the Museum of Macedonia for cultural context.

Tetovo, North Macedonia

Culture, art & music
Arabati Baba Tekke; Galilnik Summer Wedding Festival.

Markets & fashion
Tetovo Green Market and the town centre bazaar streets.

Handicraft places
Visit the Painted Mosque (Šarena Džamija) for its distinctive decorative art; look for local embroidery and textile sellers in the town market.

Tirana, Albania

Culture, art & music
National History Museum; Bunk'Art museums.

Markets & fashion
Pazari i Ri (New Bazaar); Blloku boutiques; Krujë Old Bazaar (day trip).

Handicraft places
Krujë Old Bazaar for felt caps, filigree, carved wood and rugs; Toptani Shopping Centre and local galleries for contemporary Albanian design.

Prizren, Kosovo

Culture, art & music
DokuFest Documentary Film Festival (August).

Markets & fashion
Shadërvan Square; Prizren Old Bazaar streets.

Handicraft places
Old Bazaar workshops and shops for silver filigree, jewellery and traditional handmade souvenirs; look for demonstrations during local craft events.

Pristina, Kosovo

Culture, art & music

National Library; Kosovo Museum; Ethnographic Museum (Emin Gjiku).

Markets & fashion

Pristina Green Market; Mother Teresa Boulevard shops; Peja Old Bazaar (day trip).

Handicraft places

Ethnological Museum (Emin Gjiku) for traditional craft context; Peja Old Bazaar for regional handmade products and filigree. North Africa

North Africa

12 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Marrakesh, Morocco

Culture, art & music
Storytellers and musicians at Jemaa el-Fnaa; Bahia Palace; Ben Youssef Madrasa.

Markets & fashion
Souk Semmarine; Souk Attarine; Souk Cherratine; Souk Zrabi; Souk des Teinturiers (dyers' souk).

Handicraft places
Souk Attarine for brass and copper; Souk Cherratine for leather; Souk Zrabi for carpets; Souk Fekharine for pottery; dyers' souk for textiles. These souks are organised around traditional craft trades.

Retain the trade-specific souk structure: Semmarine for mixed artisan goods, Attarine for brass/copper, and leather/dyeing souks for hides and textiles. Avoid guaranteeing a particular workshop is operating. [12]

Essaouira, Morocco

Culture, art & music
Gnawa Music Festival (June); galleries featuring local and Gnawa-inspired art.

Markets & fashion
Essaouira Medina souks; central market near Bab Marrakech; shops along the old ramparts.

Handicraft places
Skala de la Ville and the old casemates for thuya-wood marquetry workshops; medina jewellers for silver and copper work; local argan-oil cooperatives.

Tangier, Morocco

Culture, art & music
Kasbah Museum; American Legation Museum; Cinémathèque de Tanger; Librairie des Colonnes.

Markets & fashion
Grand Socco; Petit Socco; Tangier Medina souks.

Handicraft places
Explore the medina lanes around Petit Socco and Grand Socco for leatherwork, textiles and traditional goods; watch for local leather artisans.

Rabat, Morocco

Culture, art & music
Mohammed VI Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art; Bab Rouah Gallery.

Markets & fashion
Rue des Consuls; Souk Sebbat; Souika Street; Rabat Medina.

Handicraft places
Rue des Consuls for silver jewellery and Rabat carpets; Souk Sebbat and Souika for leather goods, slippers and fabrics; Oulja craft complex in Salé for pottery, metalwork and basketry.

The original craft description is well supported: Rue des Consuls for silver jewellery and Rabat carpets; Souk Sebbat and Souika for leather and textiles; Oulja in Salé for pottery, wrought iron and basketry. [11]

Casablanca, Morocco

Culture, art & music
Villa des Arts; bookshops in the Habous Quarter.

Markets & fashion
Habous Quarter; Marché Central; Morocco Mall.

Handicraft places
Habous Quarter artisan shops and the Academy of Traditional Arts for zellij, wood carving and plasterwork; browse traditional craft stores around Place des Nations Unies.

Cairo, Egypt

Culture, art & music
Arabic music and literature; Grand Egyptian Museum (fully open to the public since Nov 2025); Al-Muizz Street.

Markets & fashion
Khan el-Khalili; El-Muizz Street; Tentmakers' Street (Sharia al-Khayamiya).

Handicraft places
Tentmakers' Street for hand-stitched khayamiya textiles; Khan el-Khalili for brass lanterns, copperware, jewellery and traditional souvenirs.

Update the museum reference: the Grand Egyptian Museum is fully open to the public (since 4 November 2025), not merely an anticipated opening. Add Khayamiya, Egyptian appliqué textile art, on Sharia al-Khayamiya / Street of the Tentmakers near Bab Zuweila. Use the museum's official ticketing channel and recheck timed-entry hours. [8, 9]

Alexandria, Egypt

Culture, art & music
Bibliotheca Alexandrina; Graeco-Roman Museum.

Markets & fashion
Attarine antique market; Mansheya market area; Souq El Gomaa (check operating days and current location).

Handicraft places
Browse Attarine's antique and vintage shops for decorative objects; look for local workshops and sellers of textiles, glasswork and traditional souvenirs.

Sharm El Sheikh, Egypt

Culture, art & music
Sharm El Sheikh Museum; exhibitions on Egyptian history and Sinai heritage.

Markets & fashion
Old Market (Sharm El Maya); Soho Square shops.

Handicraft places
Old Market for Sinai-inspired beadwork, woven goods, papyrus-style souvenirs and perfume oils; check that items are locally made.

Hurghada, Egypt

Culture, art & music
Hurghada Museum.

Markets & fashion
El Dahar Souk; Sheraton Road shops; Senzo Mall.

Handicraft places
El Dahar Souk for Egyptian cotton, copper lamps, wooden goods, jewellery, spices and souvenirs; ask vendors which items are locally made.

Tunis, Tunisia

Culture, art & music
Dar Ennejma Ezzahra Centre for Arab and Mediterranean Music; Bardo Museum.

Markets & fashion
Tunis Medina; Souk El Attarine; Souk des Chechias; Souk El Berka.

Handicraft places
Souk des Chechias for traditional wool caps; Souk El Berka for jewellery; Medina workshops and souks for copperwork, leather and textiles.

Djerba, Tunisia

Culture, art & music
Djerbahood street art; Guellala Heritage Museum; Lalla Hadria Museum.

Markets & fashion
Houmt Souk; Guellala village craft shops.

Handicraft places
Guellala Pottery Village and Guellala Heritage Museum for pottery demonstrations and traditional ceramics; Houmt Souk for woven goods and local crafts.

Sousse, Tunisia

Culture, art & music
Sousse Archaeological Museum; Dar Essid.

Markets & fashion
Sousse Medina souks; Souk Er-Ribba; local Sunday market.

Handicraft places
Medina workshops and souks for ceramics, leatherwork and copper lamps; look for Kairouan carpets and traditional slippers. Central Asia

Central Asia

10 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Samarkand, Uzbekistan

Culture, art & music
El Merosi Theatre performances; Afrosiyob Museum murals.

Markets & fashion
Siab Bazaar; Tashkent Street souvenir shops; stalls around Registan.

Handicraft places
Siab Bazaar and artisan workshops near Registan for ceramics, silk scarves and suzani embroidery; visit the Meros Paper Mill in Konigil for traditional paper-making.

Strengthen the craft route with Konigil village and the Meros Paper Mill, where visitors can see traditional handmade paper production. The Uzbekistan tourism authority confirms the site and demonstration-oriented visitor experience. [10]

Bukhara, Uzbekistan

Culture, art & music
Traditional folklore and costume shows at Nadir Divan-Begi Madrasa.

Markets & fashion
Tok-i Zargaron (Jewellers' Dome); Tok-i Telpak Furushon; Tok-i Sarrafon; covered trading domes.

Handicraft places
Bukhara's historic trading domes for jewellery, textiles and souvenirs; visit the Sitorai Mokhi-Khosa palace craft displays and nearby embroidery workshops.

Tashkent, Uzbekistan

Culture, art & music
Alisher Navoi Theatre; Uthman Quran at Muyi Muborak Library; State Museum of Applied Arts.

Markets & fashion
Chorsu Bazaar; Alay Bazaar; Sayilgoh Street.

Handicraft places
Chorsu Bazaar's handicraft and souvenir section; Museum of Applied Arts for traditional ceramics, textiles and woodwork.

Khiva, Uzbekistan

Culture, art & music
Lazgi, the traditional dance of Khorezm.

Markets & fashion
Ichan-Kala historic centre; covered bazaar near Allakuli Khan Madrasa.

Handicraft places
Ichan-Kala workshops for wood carving, silk carpets and embroidery; visit the craft workshops and shops near the Juma Mosque and Tash Khauli Palace.

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Culture, art & music
Museum of Kazakh Folk Musical Instruments; Kasteev State Museum of Arts; city museums and theatres.

Markets & fashion
Green Bazaar; Zhibek Zholy pedestrian street.

Handicraft places
Chamber of Skilled Trades craft fair on Zhibek Zholy; Qazaq Oner craftsmen centre; TUMAR Art Group and CACSA gallery for felt work, jewellery and contemporary Kazakh design.

Astana, Kazakhstan

Culture, art & music
Astana Opera; Shabyt Palace of Arts; National Museum of Kazakhstan.

Markets & fashion
Khan Shatyr; Green Bazaar; local souvenir shops near the National Museum.

Handicraft places
National Museum of the Republic of Kazakhstan for traditional craft collections; seek out local craft fairs and artisan pop-ups for feltwork, jewellery and leather goods.

Turkistan, Kazakhstan

Culture, art & music
Nauryz celebrations in March; Azret Sultan Museum.

Markets & fashion
Karavan Saray shopping streets; Turkistan Central Bazaar.

Handicraft places
Karavan Saray craft and souvenir shops for felt products and Kazakh-inspired handmade goods; check for seasonal artisan demonstrations.

Shymkent, Kazakhstan

Culture, art & music
Ken Baba Ethno-Park.

Markets & fashion
Shymkent Central Bazaar; Ayna Bazaar.

Handicraft places
Central Bazaar for regional textiles, felt products and handmade souvenirs; confirm local artisans and workshop locations before visiting.

Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan

Culture, art & music
Traditional Kyrgyz music at the Philharmonic; Opera and Ballet Theatre; Gapar Aitiev Museum of Fine Arts.

Markets & fashion
Osh Bazaar; Dordoi Bazaar; Alamedin Bazaar.

Handicraft places
Osh Bazaar for kalpak hats and felt goods; CACSA Gallery and TUMAR Art Group for curated Kyrgyz crafts; Kochkor village women's cooperatives (day trip) for shyrdak and ala-kiyiz felt-making demonstrations.

Dushanbe, Tajikistan

Culture, art & music
Gurminj Museum of Musical Instruments; Pamiri music; National Museum of Tajikistan.

Markets & fashion
Mehrgon Market; Shah Mansur Bazaar; local craft shops near Rudaki Avenue.

Handicraft places
Mehrgon Market for local textiles and souvenirs; National Museum of Tajikistan for traditional embroidery and craft displays; ask about chakan and suzani workshops. Russia

Russia

1 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Kazan, Russia

Culture, art & music

Tatar culture; Galiasgar Kamal Tatar Theatre; National Museum of Tatarstan.

Markets & fashion

Kazan Kremlin souvenir shops; Bauman Street; Central Market.

Handicraft places

Kazan Kremlin craft and souvenir shops and the Chak-Chak Museum shop for Tatar-themed gifts; look for ichigi leather boots, tubeteika caps and Tatar leather mosaic products. Southeast & South Asia

Southeast & South Asia

9 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Bali, Indonesia

Culture, art & music
Gamelan music; Legong and Kecak dance performances.

Markets & fashion
Ubud Art Market; Sukawati Art Market; Seminyak boutiques.

Handicraft places
Mas village for woodcarving workshops; Celuk village for silver jewellery; Ubud Art Market for locally made crafts and textiles.

Yogyakarta, Indonesia

Culture, art & music
Batik; gamelan; puppet theatre; wayang kulit at Sonobudoyo Museum; Kraton classical dance.

Markets & fashion
Beringharjo Market; Malioboro Street; Kotagede shops.

Handicraft places
Batik workshops around Taman Sari and the Kraton; Kotagede for silver workshops; Sonobudoyo Museum for wayang and traditional craft heritage.

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Culture, art & music
Islamic Arts Museum Malaysia; National Museum.

Markets & fashion
Central Market (Pasar Seni); Petaling Street; Jalan Tuanku Abdul Rahman; Bukit Bintang.

Handicraft places
Central Market’s craft stalls and the National Craft Complex (Kompleks Kraf Kuala Lumpur) for batik, songket, woodcarving and Malaysian artisan products.

Penang, Malaysia

Culture, art & music
Khoo Kongsi carvings; George Town street art.

Markets & fashion
Little India in George Town; Chowrasta Market; Batu Ferringhi Night Market.

Handicraft places
Penang Batik Factory for batik demonstrations and products; George Town’s Armenian Street and craft shops for Nyonya beadwork, ceramics and wood carving.

Langkawi, Malaysia

Culture, art & music
Langkawi Craft Complex; Heritage Museum; Customs and Wedding Museum.

Markets & fashion
Kuah night market (check weekday location); Padang Matsirat night market; Kuah duty-free shops.

Handicraft places
Langkawi Craft Complex at Teluk Yu for Malaysian crafts, a Heritage Museum, a Customs & Wedding Museum and interactive craft activities; Faizy Crystal Glass Blowing for glassmaking.

The Langkawi Craft Complex is an official craft destination with a sales gallery, heritage and customs/wedding museums, and interactive craft activities. Check the current programme before promising a specific demonstration. [15]

Malé, Maldives

Culture, art & music
National Museum; Sultan Park.

Markets & fashion
Local Market; Majeedhee Magu; Chaandhanee Magu.

Handicraft places
National Museum for traditional objects; local craft and souvenir shops around the Local Market for lacquerwork, woven mats and miniature dhonis.

Baa Atoll, Maldives

Culture, art & music
Traditional island life, fishing heritage and local cultural activities on inhabited islands.

Markets & fashion
Local shops in inhabited islands; Thulhaadhoo village shops.

Handicraft places
Thulhaadhoo is known for traditional lacquerwork (liyelaa jehun); ask local guesthouses or community tourism providers about visiting artisans.

Hunza Valley, Pakistan

Culture, art & music
Sacred Rocks of Hunza and traditional carvings.

Markets & fashion
Karimabad Bazaar; Aliabad Bazaar; local stalls near Baltit Fort.

Handicraft places
Karimabad Bazaar and shops around Baltit Fort for handwoven wool shawls, embroidered textiles, gemstones and locally made souvenirs; ask about women’s craft cooperatives.

Skardu, Pakistan

Culture, art & music
Manthal Buddha Rock; Balti music and seasonal festivals.

Markets & fashion
Skardu Main Bazaar; Hussaini Chowk market area.

Handicraft places
Skardu Bazaar for Balti woollens, caps, embroidered garments, gemstones and woodwork; ask local tourism offices about craft demonstrations and artisan cooperatives. Thailand

Thailand

2 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Satun, Thailand

Culture, art & music
Satun National Museum (Ku Den Mansion); local Malay-Muslim heritage and coastal community life.

Markets & fashion
Satun Walking Street / local night market (check operating days); Satun town market.

Handicraft places
Satun National Museum (Ku Den Mansion) for local heritage; ask at local tourism offices about batik and woven-textile workshops, as named permanent craft centres are limited.

Koh Lanta, Thailand

Culture, art & music
Lanta Old Town; local fishing and sea-gypsy heritage.

Markets & fashion
Lanta Old Town shops; Saladan Village market and walking street.

Handicraft places
Lanta Old Town for locally made souvenirs and community products; ask local community tourism operators about batik, weaving and traditional fishing-craft demonstrations. India

India

4 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Kozhikode, India

Culture, art & music
UNESCO City of Literature; Mappila songs; Oppana.

Markets & fashion
S.M. Street (Mittai Theruvu); Valiyangadi Market; Beypore market area.

Handicraft places
Beypore Uru shipbuilding yards and Beypore Pulimuttu for traditional wooden dhow-building heritage; visit local workshops where access is permitted.

Strengthen the entry with two locally rooted traditions: Uru wooden dhow construction at Beypore and Oppana / Mappila Pattu. Uru activity is order-dependent, so a working shipyard or demonstration is not guaranteed on a given day. [13, 14]

Lakshadweep, India

Culture, art & music
Lava dance from Minicoy; Kolkali and Parichakali dances.

Markets & fashion
Agatti and Kavaratti local markets; Minicoy village shops.

Handicraft places
Minicoy and island coir units for coconut and coir products; ask island tourism offices about local makers and demonstrations.

Hyderabad, India

Culture, art & music
Salar Jung Museum; Nizam's Museum.

Markets & fashion
Laad Bazaar; Pathergatti; Sultan Bazaar; Shilparamam arts and crafts village.

Handicraft places
Shilparamam in Madhapur for artisan stalls and demonstrations; Bidriware craft workshops and outlets; Laad Bazaar for traditional bangles.

Lucknow, India

Culture, art & music
Urdu poetry; Kathak dance; traditional calligraphy at Chota Imambara.

Markets & fashion
Chowk; Aminabad; Hazratganj; Janpath Market.

Handicraft places
Chowk and Aminabad for Chikankari embroidery shops; Rifa-e-Aam Club and local artisan boutiques may host craft exhibitions; confirm current events. East Africa

East Africa

1 destination entries · Use the three sections to plan a cultural visit, shopping walk and craft-focused stop.

Zanzibar City (Stone Town), Tanzania

Culture, art & music

Taarab music; Dhow Countries Music Academy; Palace Museum.

Markets & fashion

Darajani Market; Gizenga Street; Hurumzi Street shops.

Handicraft places

Stone Town’s Hurumzi Street and Gizenga Street for carved doors, woodwork and locally made crafts; Darajani Market for kanga and kikoi fabrics.

Retain Taarab as a living Swahili-coast music tradition, not a guaranteed nightly tourist show. UNESCO’s October 2026 reporting describes current community-based safeguarding and inventory work in Zanzibar. [16]

Visitor playbook: turning a listing into a reliable experience

Before you go

Check the official venue page for opening hours, ticketing, closures and photography rules. For a market, verify its operating day and exact location; some markets rotate by weekday or season.

For workshops

Contact the venue or artisan cooperative directly. Ask whether visitors can observe, whether hands-on participation is offered, whether booking is required, the duration, language availability and the fee.

For performances

Treat traditional music and dance as living community practices. Confirm the event date and venue, and prefer community-run or institutionally presented programmes over unverified street-performance claims.

For craft purchases

Ask about maker identity, materials, production location, technique, care instructions and shipping. For antiques, carpets, jewellery or culturally protected objects, ask for receipts and export documentation before purchase.

For respectful photography

Ask permission before photographing artisans, performers, residents or worship spaces. Respect restricted areas and local dress and conduct expectations.

For accessibility and family visits

Confirm step-free access, child suitability, restroom facilities, heat exposure and transport arrangements directly with the venue.

Selected sources

Official and destination-authority references for further information on selected places and cultural traditions.

1. Visit Dubai — Alserkal Avenue guide (11 Aug 2025)
2. UNESCO — Sharjah World Book Capital 2019
3. Sharjah Art Foundation — venues and visitor information
4. UNESCO — Al Talli (UAE), inscribed 2022
5. Experience Abu Dhabi — House of Artisans
6. UNESCO — Traditional weaving of Al Sadu (Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Qatar; 2025 extension)
7. Türkiye Ministry of Culture — Avanos pottery
8. Egypt State Information Service — Grand Egyptian Museum full opening (4 Nov 2025)
9. Grand Egyptian Museum — official ticketing and visitor hours
10. Uzbekistan Travel — Konigil village and Meros Paper Mill
11. Visit Morocco — Rabat handicraft shopping
12. Visit Morocco — Marrakech souks and craft trades
13. Kerala Tourism — Uru-making in Beypore, Kozhikode
14. Kerala Tourism — Oppana
15. Kraftangan Malaysia — Langkawi Craft Complex
16. UNESCO — Taarab safeguarding in Zanzibar (19 Oct 2026)